

German — Complete Notes

Everything covered so far, in study format

Rebuilt 2026-09-18

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COMPLETE NOTES — Everything, in study format

Generated 2026-09-18 from the whole repository: GRAMMAR.md, VOCABULARY.md, ANSWERS.md (Q1–Q23), ERROR_LOG.md (~70 entries), PRONOUN_TABLE.md, STUDY_PLAN.md and the daily notes.

This file is a study document, not a tracker. It does not replace the trackers — it is the thing to read and revise from. If you study only this file, you have covered everything taught so far.

How to use it: Part I–VII are the grammar. Part VIII is vocabulary. Part IX is the error catalogue (your actual mistakes — the highest-value section). Part X is tips, traps and method.

This file is kept live. By standing rule, every time anything is logged to the trackers, this document is updated too and `build_notes.sh` is re-run to refresh `Complete Notes.tex` and `Complete Notes.pdf`. The PDF is the study copy — it should never lag behind the trackers. (*The .tex and .pdf are generated from this Markdown — don't edit them directly.*)

PART I — THE FOUNDATION

1.1 The two core verbs

sein (to be) — irregular, must be memorised.

ich bin	wir sind
du bist	ihr seid
er/sie/es ist	sie/Sie sind

haben (to have) — irregular in du/er forms.

ich habe	wir haben
du hast	ihr habt
er/sie/es hat	sie/Sie haben

! Your recorded mistakes here: “Was haben du?” (-> hast), “habst” (-> hast), “Ich haben gegessen” (-> habe), “Er is nicht” (-> ist, English spelling leaking in), “Du bust” (-> bist).

1.2 Feelings: two constructions, never mixed

German expresses feelings two ways, and they cannot be combined:

- **sein + adjective:** Ich bin hungrig. / Ich bin müde.
- **haben + noun:** Ich habe Hunger. / Ich habe Durst.

(wrong) “Ich habe hungrig” — mixes the two. This was your first logged error.

1.3 Noun capitalization

Every German noun is always capitalized, everywhere in the sentence, not just proper names: das Buch, die Katze, der Hunger, die Zeit.

! Recorded slips: “buch”, “Hunger” written lowercase.

But: **infinitives and separable prefixes stay lowercase** unless genuinely nominalized. - Ich sehe fern. (prefix, lowercase) vs das Fernsehen (the noun) - Ich kann schwimmen. (infinitive) vs das Schwimmen (the activity)

! Recorded 3× as a pattern: “Fern”, “Schwimmen” wrongly capitalized.

1.4 sie vs Sie — the capitalization that changes meaning

Form	Meaning	Verb
sie (lowercase)	she	sie ist
sie (lowercase)	they	sie sind
Sie (always capital)	you (formal)	Sie sind

Mid-sentence, capitalization is the only thing distinguishing them: - “Die Frau ist glücklich, denn **sie** hat ein Buch.” (she) - “**Sie** haben ein Buch.” (you, formal)

ihr is never formal — it is informal plural “you all” only. Formal is always **Sie + sind**, singular or plural. (ANSWERS Q1, Q2)

PART II — ARTICLES, GENDER, AND THE CASE SYSTEM

2.1 The article table — the single most load-bearing table in German

	der-word (masc)	die-word (fem)	das-word (neut)	plural
Nominative (subject)	der	die	das	die
Accusative (direct obj)	den	die	das	die
Dative (indirect obj)	dem	der	dem	den (+ -n on noun)

Notice: in accusative, ONLY the der-word changes. That single fact carries over everywhere — pronouns, possessives, everything.

Indefinite: ein (der / das) / eine (die) -> accusative **einen** (der-word only) -> dative **einem** (der / das) / **einer** (die).

2.2 The four cases — what each one marks

1. **Nominative** — the subject. Who/what is doing the verb.
2. **Accusative** — the direct object. What the verb is done TO.
3. **Dative** — the indirect object. The receiver/beneficiary.
4. **Genitive** — possession (not yet taught).

! The misconception you formed and had corrected (2026-09-10): case is NOT decided by whether a verb is an “action verb” or not. It is decided by the noun’s ROLE in the sentence. haben, sehen, geben — all take accusative direct objects. Nothing about “action-ness” is involved.

2.3 When accusative applies

Accusative = direct object of a verb. (ANSWERS Q6)

Verbs that take accusative objects: haben, sehen, essen, trinken, kaufen, lesen, nehmen — most “doing” verbs.

The one big exception: sein never takes accusative. “To be” doesn’t act on anything, it equates two things, so nouns after sein stay nominative.

- (correct) Das ist **mein** Hund. (not meinen — sein-sentence)

- (correct) Ist das **dein** Hund? (same reason)

! Recorded 2×: “Ist das deinen Hund?” — accusative over-applied after sein. (ANSWERS Q4)

Modal verbs do not change any of this. (ANSWERS Q7) The second verb (the infinitive at the end) decides the case, exactly as it would alone: - Ich möchte **den Hund** sehen. (sehen takes accusative)
- Ich kann schlafen. (schlafen takes no object)

2.4 When dative applies — TWO separate causes

Cause 1: the indirect object (the receiver, usually a person).

Ich gebe dem Mann ein Buch. dem Mann = dative (receiver) · ein Buch = accusative (thing given)

Cause 2: certain prepositions simply demand it, regardless of role.

Er spielt mit mir. — mir isn’t receiving anything; *mit* forces dative.

These are genuinely two different mechanisms producing the same endings.

2.5 Dative-only verbs ! HIGH-PRIORITY WEAK SPOT

Some verbs take a dative object even though there is only ONE object and it looks like a direct object in English:

- **helfen** — Ich helfe **ihr**. (not sie)
- **danken** — Ich danke **ihm**. (not ihn)
- **gehören** — Das Buch gehört **mir**. (not mich)
- gefallen, antworten (same family)

English “I help her” *looks* like a direct object. German treats the person as a recipient.

! **This is a confirmed regression cluster.** 3/3 clean on 2026-09-10, then 1/3 on 2026-09-17 (“Ich danke ihn” (wrong), “Das Buch gehört mich” (wrong)). You correctly identify the verbs as dative-only — you then pick the wrong form. **Drill: mir/dir/ihm/ihr, not mich/dich/ihn/sie.**

PART III — PRONOUNS

3.1 The full table

Nominative	Accusative	Dative
ich — I	mich	mir
du — you	dich	dir
er — he	ihn	ihm
sie — she	sie	ihr
es — it	es	ihm
wir — we	uns	uns
ihr — you all	euch	euch
sie — they	sie	ihnen
Sie — you (formal)	Sie	Ihnen

What to notice: 1. Only four dative forms are genuinely new: mir, dir, ihm, ihnen. 2. **er changes**

twice (er->ihn->ihm), mirroring der->den->dem exactly. 3. **es and sie barely move** — only the dative shifts them: es->ihm, sie->ihr.

! es/sie dative swap — RECURRING, 3 occurrences (2026-09-10, again 2026-09-17). You give **ihm** for both es and sie. Correct: es->ihm, sie->ihr. This is your most persistent pronoun error.

3.2 The “ihr” trap — three separate jobs

Form	Job	Example
ihr	“you all” (nominative)	Ihr habt ein Buch
ihr	“to her” (dative)	Ich gebe ihr ein Buch
ihr/ihre	“her” (possessive)	Ihre Katze ist müde
Ihr/Ihnen (capital)	formal “your” / “to you”	Ist das Ihr Buch?

The verb form usually disambiguates: *ihr habt* (you all) vs *ihr gibt* (impossible as a subject -> must be dative).

3.3 THE BIG PRONOUN TRAP — gender, not meaning (ANSWERS Q11)

A German pronoun follows the noun’s GRAMMATICAL GENDER, never the English meaning, never whether it is a person or a thing.

Three-step method: 1. Find the noun being replaced. 2. Recall its article — der/die/das. 3. Convert: der->er/ihn · die->sie/sie · das->es/es

Sentence	Pronoun	Why
Ich sehe den Tisch -> Ich sehe ihn	ihn	der-word
Ich habe das Buch -> Ich habe es	es	das-word
Sie kauft die Milch -> Sie kauft sie	sie	die-word
Ich esse einen Apfel -> Ich esse ihn	ihn	der Apfel

The trap, stated plainly: - **der Apfel** is a thing, but takes **ihn** — literally “I eat him.” Correct. - **das Kind** is a person, but takes **es** — “she sees it.” Correct. - **das Mädchen** (girl) -> **es**. Yes, really.

If a German pronoun feels wrong to your English ear, that is expected and is not a sign of error.

Practical self-check: say the noun WITH its article first — “*der Apfel*” -> der -> ihn. Side effect: if you can’t recall the article, you can’t choose the pronoun. **That is why nouns must always be learned with der/die/das attached.**

! Recorded 2× (same check, opposite directions): pronouns chosen by English semantics instead of gender.

3.4 Possessives take the same endings

	der/das-word	die-word	plural
Nominative	mein Vater / unser Auto	meine Mutter	meine Eltern
Accusative	meinen Vater	meine Mutter	meine Eltern
Dative	meinem Vater	meiner Mutter	meinen Eltern

Same pattern for dein-, sein-, ihr-, unser-, Ihr-.

! Critical correction you needed twice: the **-en** ending is **DATIVE plural**, not “plural in general.”
 - (correct) mit **unseren** Eltern (dative — mit forces it) - (correct) gegen **unsere** Eltern (accusative plural — NO -en)

You have twice stated the rule as “plural always takes -en” (2026-09-08, 2026-09-17). That is the misconception to kill. (ANSWERS Q14)

3.5 uns vs unser- (ANSWERS Q13)

- **uns** = PRONOUN, “us” — Er sieht **uns**.
- **unser-** = POSSESSIVE, “our” — **unsere** Eltern, mit **unseren** Eltern

Same shape as the ihr/ihre confusion: a pronoun and its look-alike possessive are two different words with two different jobs.

PART IV — NEGATION

4.1 nicht vs kein — the decision (ANSWERS Q3, Q8, Q9, Q10)

Use **kein/keine** when negating a noun that would otherwise take ein/eine or no article (indefinite/general): - Ich habe **keinen** Hund. (vs “ein Hund”) - Ich habe **keine** Zeit. (Zeit normally takes no article)

Use **nicht** when: - Negating a verb: Ich arbeite **nicht**. - Negating an adjective: Ich bin **nicht** müde.
 - Negating a **specific/definite** noun (der/die/das): Ich sehe den Hund **nicht**.

kein takes the same endings as **ein**: keinen Hund (acc. der-word), keine Zeit, kein Buch.

4.2 Why “kein den Hund” is impossible (ANSWERS Q9)

kein and **der/die/das** are mutually exclusive — **kein** REPLACES the article slot. **nicht** doesn’t touch the article at all.

- **kein** = article-equivalent -> “Ich habe **keinen** Hund” (no separate ein)
- **nicht** = separate word, article stays -> “Ich sehe **den** Hund **nicht**”

Two articles cannot attach to one noun, which is what “kein den Hund” would be.

The real trigger: was there originally an ein/eine (or no article)? -> **kein** replaces it. Was there a der/die/das? -> keep it, add **nicht**.

4.3 Where nicht goes (ANSWERS Q18) ! RECURRING

nicht sits as close to the end as possible, but **BEFORE** whatever it negates (verb, infinitive, or separable prefix): - Ich sehe **nicht** fern. - Er kann **nicht** schwimmen. - Ich stehe um sieben Uhr **nicht** auf.

A definite object comes BEFORE nicht, because the object is not what is being negated — it’s established information: - (correct) Ich sehe **den Hund nicht**. - (wrong) Ich sehe nicht den Hund. - (correct) So kann er **den Hund nicht** sehen.

! You have forgotten this twice after gaps (2026-09-11, 2026-09-15) and self-corrected both times once pointed back to the rule.

4.4 keine Zeit vs nicht viel Zeit (ANSWERS Q3)

Not interchangeable: - **Wir haben keine Zeit**. — no time at all, complete negation. - **Wir haben nicht viel Zeit**. — some time exists, just not much. (**nicht** negates *viel*, the quantifier — consistent

with the rule, not an exception.)

PART V — PREPOSITIONS

5.1 Dative prepositions — always dative, no exceptions

mit, nach, bei, von, zu, aus, seit (+ außer)

Mnemonic rhyme: *aus, außer, bei, mit, nach, seit, von, zu*

Every one of them forces dative on whatever follows: - mit **dem** Hund · bei **der** Arbeit · seit **dem** Jahr - von **der** Arbeit · aus **dem** Haus · zu **meiner** Mutter

! Your recurring habit: dropping the article entirely — “von Arbeit”, “nach Wochenende”, “von Schule”. Logged 4+ times. A dative preposition ALWAYS keeps its article.

5.2 Accusative prepositions — always accusative

FUDGO: für, um, durch, gegen, ohne

- Das Buch ist **für** dich.
- Wir gehen **durch** den Park.
- Ich esse Brot **ohne** Milch.
- Wir spielen **gegen** unsere Eltern. ! (not unseren — see 3.4)
- Ich stehe **um** sieben Uhr auf.

5.3 Two-way prepositions ! NEEDED 4 REFRESHERS — your hardest topic

in, an, auf, über, unter, vor, hinter, neben, zwischen

The ONLY thing to memorise — one question:

Question	Meaning	Case
wohin? (where TO?)	movement into/onto	ACCUSATIVE
wo? (where?)	static location, no movement	DATIVE

Worked pairs: - Ich gehe **ins** Zimmer. (motion -> acc) / Ich bin **im** Zimmer. (location -> dat) - Ich gehe **in** den Garten. (motion) / Der Hund ist **im** Garten. (location) - Er legt das Buch **auf** den Tisch. (motion) / Die Katze sitzt **auf** dem Tisch. (location)

Contractions: in+das -> **ins** · in+dem -> **im** · an+das -> **ans** · an+dem -> **am**

! Your actual friction points (diagnosed 2026-09-15): the *wohin/wo* *concept* lands fine. What breaks is (a) matching the case to the right sentence under time pressure, and (b) der-word gender inside the phrase (der Garten -> dem/den, not der).

! New confusion (2026-09-15): using **nach** for motion into a room. **nach** is NEVER used for entering an enclosed space. “Ich gehe **in** den Raum,” not “nach der Raum.”

5.4 nach vs zu — destinations (ANSWERS Q15, Q16)

nach — destinations with NO article: - Cities/countries: nach Berlin, nach Deutschland, nach München, nach Spanien - Directions: nach links, nach oben - **ALSO means “after” (time)** — nach dem Wochenende, nach dem Termin. Completely different job, always dative.

zu — destinations that DO take an article: - People: zu meiner Mutter - Places: zur Schule, zum Bahnhof, zum Arzt, zur Post - Events: zur Arbeit

Test: does the destination normally take der/die/das? No -> nach. Yes -> zu.

Contractions: zu+dem -> **zum** · zu+der -> **zur**

! Possessives never contract (ANSWERS Q20): “zu **meiner** Mutter,” never “zur Mutter” (that would mean “to THE mother”).

Both prepositions can appear in one sentence doing different jobs: > Wir gehen **nach dem Termin** (after — time) **zum Arzt** (to — destination).

Word order: **time before place** — see Part VI.

Exception for later: some countries take an article and use “in” — in die Schweiz, in die USA.

5.5 aus vs von — both mean “from”

- **aus** = exiting an enclosed space, or origin/nationality
 - Ich komme **aus** Indien. · Ich komme **aus dem** Haus.
- **von** = the general “coming from [a place you were]”
 - Sie kommt **von der** Arbeit. · Er kommt **von der** Schule.

! Still ACTIVE, not yet drilled. “Er kommt aus die Schule” -> should be **von der** Schule.

5.6 Fixed idioms that break the rules

- **zu Hause** = “at home” — a fixed phrase, NOT zur Haus / im Haus / die Haus
- **an der Ecke** = “on the corner” (location) — an, not in
- **zur Ecke** = “to the corner” (destination)

PART VI — WORD ORDER

6.1 Verb-second (V2) — the backbone rule

The conjugated verb is always in the SECOND POSITION — second *slot*, not second *word*. Position 1 can hold a whole phrase.

Position 1	Position 2 (VERB)	Rest
Ich	esse	heute einen Apfel
Heute	esse	ich einen Apfel
Am Wochenende	gehe	ich ins Kino
Weil ich müde bin,	bleibe	ich zu Hause

When something else takes position 1, **the subject moves after the verb.**

Tip: Your own insight (2026-09-17), and it's correct: fronting changes emphasis. “Mein Vater arbeitet heute” foregrounds the father; “Heute arbeitet mein Vater” foregrounds the day.

6.2 Yes/no questions — verb FIRST

Verb and subject swap places: - Du bist müde. -> **Bist du** müde? - Sie wohnt in Berlin. -> **Wohnt sie** in Berlin? - Er kann schwimmen. -> **Kann er** schwimmen? - Du hast Zeit. -> **Hast du** Zeit? ! (not “Habt du”)

6.3 W-questions — question word first, verb second

Wer, was, wo, wann, warum, wie, wohin. > **Wo ist** der Mann? · **Was hast** du? · **Wie geht's** dir?

6.4 Subordinate clauses — weil sends the verb to the END ! REGRESSED

weil (because) pushes its own clause's verb to the very end: - Weil ich müde **bin**, ... - Weil es **regnet**, ...

AND the main clause still needs verb-second — because the entire weil-clause occupies position 1:

Weil es regnet, bleibe ich zu Hause. ^ position 1 (whole clause) ^ position 2 (verb) ^ subject third

(wrong) "Weil bin ich müde, ich bleibe..." — both halves wrong.

denn (because) is different — it's a coordinating conjunction like und / aber / oder, so it does NOT send the verb to the end: > Ich bleibe zu Hause, **denn ich bin** müde. (normal order both halves)

! Status: the two halves of this rule have failed in *alternation* — 09-11 the main clause broke, 09-15 the weil-clause broke. Both halves need to hold at once.

6.5 Time — Manner — Place (ANSWERS Q21)

After the verb, elements order as **Time -> Manner -> Place**: > Ich gehe **heute** (time) **mit meiner Mutter** (manner) **nach Berlin** (place).

Time words sit right after the conjugated verb: > Ich muss **heute** schlafen.

This is the opposite of English, which tends to put place before time. This is why "Wir gehen **nach dem Termin zum Arzt**" has the time phrase first.

6.6 Separable verbs

In a normal present-tense sentence, the **prefix splits off and goes to the very end**: - aufstehen -> Ich **stehe** um sieben Uhr **auf**. - anrufen -> Ich **rufe** dich **an**. - fernsehen -> Ich **sehe** gern **fern**.

With a modal verb, it does NOT split — it goes to the end whole, as an infinitive: - Ich muss um sieben Uhr **aufstehen**.

With nicht: nicht goes right before the prefix. - Ich stehe um sieben Uhr **nicht auf**.

PART VII — VERBS BEYOND THE PRESENT

7.1 Modal verbs

	können (can)	müssen (must)	möchten (would like)
ich	kann	muss	möchte
du	kannst	musst	möchtest
er/sie/es	kann	muss	möchte
wir	können	müssen	möchten
ihr	könnt	müsst	möchtet
sie/Sie	können	müssen	möchten

Structure: the modal conjugates and sits in **position 2**; the second verb goes to the **very end in plain infinitive form**. > Ich **muss** heute **schlafen**. · **Kann** er **schwimmen**?

Modals never have their own object — see ANSWERS Q7 / section 2.3.

7.2 The imperative (commands)

Form	How	Example
du	drop the -st ending	du gibst -> Gib mir das Buch!
ihr	plain ihr-form, no pronoun	ihr esst -> Esst das Brot!
Sie	infinitive + Sie stated, verb first	Kommen Sie herein!

- Stem-change e->i/ie **is kept**: geben -> **Gib**! · sehen -> **Sieh**!
- Umlaut stem-changes are **dropped**: fahren -> **Fahr**! (not Fähr!)

! Sie-form must keep the pronoun — “Kommen herein” (wrong) -> “Kommen **Sie** herein!” (correct)

Object cases don't change in the imperative: “Gib **mir** das Buch” — mir is dative (receiver), das Buch accusative. Same as any other sentence.

7.3 Perfekt — the conversational past ! NEWEST TOPIC

Structure: helper verb (**haben** or **sein**, conjugated, position 2) + **past participle at the very end**.

Ich **habe** gestern Fußball **gespielt**. Ich **bin** ins Kino **gegangen**.

Which helper? (ANSWERS Q22)

sein for: - **Motion between two places**: gehen, kommen, fahren, fliegen, laufen - **Change of state**: aufstehen, einschlafen, sterben, werden - **Two memorised exceptions**: sein (ich bin gewesen), bleiben (ich bin geblieben)

haben for everything else — including “static” verbs that feel physical: stehen, sitzen, schlafen, spielen, arbeiten.

Test: moving from place A to place B, or genuinely changing state? -> sein. Otherwise -> haben.

! **Counter-intuitive**: *stehen* is haben (you're not going anywhere). *spielen* is haben. *bleiben* is sein despite not being motion.

Participle formation

- **Regular (weak)**: ge + stem + t -> machen -> **gemacht**, spielen -> **gespielt**, kaufen -> **gekauft**
- **Irregular (strong)**: ge + (often changed) stem + **en** — must be memorised per verb, like English go->went.
- **Separable verbs**: ge- goes **BETWEEN prefix and stem** -> einschlafen -> **ein-ge-schlafen** (NOT “geeinschlafen”), aufstehen -> **auf-ge-standen**

Irregular participles covered so far

Verb	Participle	Helper
gehen	gegangen (e->a)	sein
kommen	gekommen	sein
fahren	gefahren (no umlaut!)	sein
fliegen	geflogen	sein
bleiben	geblieben	sein
einschlafen	eingeschlafen	sein

Verb	Participle	Helper
sehen	gesehen	haben
lesen	gelesen	haben
essen	gegessen	haben
trinken	getrunken	haben
stehen	gestanden	haben

! **Your errors:** “gefährten” (invented umlaut -> gefahren), “gebleibt” (regularised an irregular verb -> geblieben), “gegeinschlafen” (ge- at the front -> eingeschlafen).

! THE MISCONCEPTION TO KILL (ANSWERS Q23)

sein-vs-haben and regular-vs-irregular are COMPLETELY INDEPENDENT. There is no correlation:

Verb	Regular?	Helper
gehen	irregular	sein
arbeiten	regular	haben
bleiben	irregular	sein
kaufen	regular	haben
kommen	irregular	sein

You proposed “irregular verbs need sein” — this is false. Helper choice is about **meaning** (motion/state-change). Participle spelling is about **memorisation**. Two separate systems.

7.4 Stem-changing verbs (present tense)

Some verbs change their stem vowel in **du** and **er/sie/es** forms only:

Verb	du	er / sie / es
essen	isst	isst
sehen	siehst	sieht
lesen	liest	liest
geben	gibst	gibt
schlafen	schläfst	schläft
tragen	trägst	trägt
fahren	fährst	fährt
helfen	hilfst	hilft

! **ich never changes:** ich esse, ich sehe, ich **helfe** (not “hilfe”), ich gebe.

7.5 leben vs wohnen (ANSWERS Q17)

- **wohnen** = to reside, have an address -> Ich **wohne** in Würzburg.
- **leben** = to be alive / lifestyle / to live WITH people -> Er **lebt** mit seiner Mutter.

Address question -> wohnen. Living *with* someone, or life in general -> leben.

7.6 mögen vs gern

- **mögen** pairs with a **NOUN**: Ich **mag** Musik.
- **gern** pairs with a **VERB**: Ich lese **gern**. / Ich sehe **gern** fern.

! Recorded 2×: “Ich mag kochen” -> should be “Ich koche **gern**.”

7.7 geben — the dative/accusative double-object verb

Ich gebe dem Mann ein Buch. — dem Mann (dative receiver) + ein Buch (accusative thing)

Order: **dative before accusative** when both are nouns.

! **zu** is **redundant with geben** — the dative already means “to”: (wrong) “Er gibt das Buch **zu** seiner Mutter” -> (correct) “Er gibt **seiner Mutter** das Buch.”

! **geben/gehen swap** — recorded in both directions, 2 instances.

PART VIII — VOCABULARY

8.1 Greetings & phrases

German	English
Hallo	hello
Guten Morgen / Tag / Abend	good morning / day / evening
Gute Nacht	good night
Tschüss	bye (informal)
Auf Wiedersehen	goodbye (formal)
Bis später / bis bald	see you later / soon
Wie geht's?	how's it going?
Mir geht's gut	I'm doing well
Entschuldigung	excuse me / sorry
bitte	please
danke	thank you
kein Problem	no problem
noch mal	again / one more time
Gute Reise	have a good trip
Mach's gut	take care

! It is **Guten** Morgen (accusative-style set phrase), never “Guter Morgen.”

8.2 People & family

der Mann (Männer) · die Frau (Frauen) · das Kind (Kinder) · die Familie · die Mutter (Mütter) · der Vater (Väter) · die Eltern (pl. only) · der Bruder (Brüder) · die Schwester (Schwestern) · der Freund (Freunde)

8.3 Food & drink

das Brot · das Hähnchen · der Reis · die Suppe · der Käse · die Milch · der Apfel (Äpfel) · das Wasser · **essen** (isst) · **trinken**

! “Äpfel” is the PLURAL. Singular is **Apfel** — don’t invent umlauts.

8.4 House & rooms

das Haus (Häuser) · das Zimmer (unchanged pl.) · der Raum (Räume) · die Küche · das Schlafzimmer · das Bad · der Tisch (Tische) · der Stuhl (Stühle) · das Fenster (unchanged pl.)

! **Tisch** = table, **Stuhl** = chair — swapped once. ! Singular is **Stuhl**, not “Stühl.”

Compound nouns take the gender of the LAST part: schlafen + das Zimmer = **das** Schlafzimmer.

8.5 Transport, directions & places in town

der Bus (Busse) · die Bahn / der Zug · die Straße (Straßen) · die Ampel (Ampeln) · die Ecke (Ecken) · **rechts** · **links** · **geradeaus** · die Bank (Banken) · der Park · das Rathaus · die Post · das Kino · das Geschäft · der Bahnhof · die Schule

Phrases: **an der Ecke** (on the corner) · **zur Post** · **zum Bahnhof** · **ins Zentrum**

8.6 Time & daily routine

die Zeit · die Uhr · **heute** (today) · **morgen** (tomorrow) · **der Morgen** (the morning — capital M!) · das Wochenende · der Termin · **aufstehen** (sep.) · **arbeiten** · **schlafen** (schläft) · **wohnen** · **leben** · **um** (at, for times)

! **morgen** (tomorrow) vs **der Morgen** (the morning) — identical except capitalization.

8.7 Weather

das Wetter · die Sonne · der Regen · **kalt** · **warm** · **regnen** (impersonal: *es regnet*)

8.8 Hobbies & activities

das Hobby (Hobbys) · **lesen** (liest) · **spielen** · **schwimmen** · die Musik · **gern** · **fernsehen** (sehe fern) · **mögen** (mag) · das Fernsehen (the noun)

8.9 Clothing & colours

das T-Shirt · die Hose · das Kleid · die Jacke · der Schuh (Schuhe) · **tragen** (trägt) · **blau** · **rot** · **grün** · **schwarz**

8.10 Shopping & money

das Geld · der Preis · **kaufen** · **kosten** · **teuer** · **billig** · die Tasche (Taschen)

8.11 Adjectives & adverbs

müde · glücklich · hungrig · gut · schön · lang · neu · **immer** (always) · **oft** (often) · **manchmal** (sometimes) · **selten** (rarely) · **nie** (never)

8.12 Question words

wer (who) · was (what) · wo (where) · wohin (where to) · wann (when) · warum (why) · wie (how)

8.13 Conjunctions

und · **aber** · **oder** · **denn** (all keep normal word order) · **weil** (sends verb to the end)

8.14 Numbers

eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf, sechs, sieben, acht, neun, zehn, elf, zwölf, dreizehn, vierzehn, fünfzehn, sechzehn, siebzehn, achtzehn, neunzehn, zwanzig

! With a number, **the article is dropped**: “zwei Hunde,” never “zweinen Hunde.”

PART IX — YOUR ERROR CATALOGUE

The highest-value section. These are your actual recorded mistakes, grouped by pattern. Everything here has happened at least once.

9.1 [HIGH] RECURRING — the ones that keep coming back

Pattern	Times	The fix
3rd-person conjugated as du-form (er hast, er siehst, er arbeitest, er trägst, er magst)	7+	Load-dependent. Correct in isolation, breaks under pressure. Embed 3rd-person subjects in mixed practice — do NOT drill in isolation
es/sie dative swap (sie->ihm instead of ihr)	3	es->ihm, sie-> ihr . er and es share ihm
den used for das-words (den Buch)	3	Load-dependent only; 8/8 in writing. Not a knowledge gap
mein/meine gender slip (mein Mutter)	3	Only in free production. die Mutter -> meine
Invented umlaut on singulars (Bröt, Äpfel, Stühl)	3	Singular is the plain form. Umlaut is the plural's job
Separable prefix capitalized (Fern, Schwimmen)	3	Lowercase unless nominalized
unseren used for accusative plural	2	-en is dative plural only
Dative preposition loses its article (von Arbeit, nach Wochenende)	4+	Dative prepositions ALWAYS keep the article
geben/gehen swap	2	Both directions recorded
mögen used with a verb (Ich mag kochen)	2	mögen+noun, gern+verb
Accusative after sein (Ist das deinen Hund?)	2	sein never takes accusative

9.2 [MED] CLUSTER REGRESSIONS — were solid, then broke

Dative-only verbs — 3/3 on 09-10 -> 1/3 on 09-17 - (wrong) Ich danke **ihn** -> **ihm** - (wrong) Das Buch gehört **mich** -> **mir** - (wrong) Ich **hilfe** -> **helfe** (ich never takes the stem change)

weil word order — the two halves fail in alternation - 09-11: main clause lost verb-second - 09-15: weil-clause lost verb-last

Two-way prepositions — needed 4 separate refreshers (09-07, 09-08, 09-10, 09-15). Concept lands; execution under pressure breaks.

9.3 [OK] RESOLVED — confirmed fixed

- **geben conjugation (gibt)** — resolved 09-07 across a genuine overnight gap
- **verb-second general rule** — resolved 09-03
- **nicht before pronoun objects** — “Er sieht uns nicht” (correct)
- **es/sie dative** — resolved 09-10 (but recurred 09-17)
- **helfen + dative** — resolved 09-10 (but cluster recurred 09-17)

- **Sie-form imperative** — resolved 09-15
- **an der Ecke** — resolved 09-16
- **nach after-vs-to** — resolved 09-15
- **nach vs two-way in** — resolved 09-15
- **ins/im location vs motion** — resolved 09-07

9.4 Misconceptions you invented and had corrected

These are worth naming because inventing a plausible-but-false rule is harder to unlearn than simply not knowing:

1. (wrong) *“nach is used when the noun is in infinitive form”* — nouns don’t have infinitives. Real rule: no-article -> nach, has-article -> zu.
2. (wrong) *“Accusative is for action verbs, dative for non-action verbs”* — case is decided by the noun’s ROLE, not the verb’s type.
3. (wrong) *“Plural always takes -en”* — that’s **dative** plural specifically.
4. (wrong) *“Irregular verbs use sein in Perfekt”* — completely independent systems.

9.5 Anglicisms & English interference

- “Chicken”, “Rice” written in English -> das Hähnchen, der Reis
- “ich stay die Haus” -> ich **bleibe zu Hause**
- “sehe TV” -> **fernsehen**
- “Er is nicht” -> **ist**
- Writing **Munich** instead of **München**

Tip: When you can’t retrieve a word, write ??? — not the English word. What you couldn’t retrieve is the most valuable data in the exercise.

PART X — TIPS, TRICKS & METHOD

10.1 Memory hooks

Hook	Covers
FUDGO <i>aus, außer, bei, mit, nach, seit, von, zu</i> wohin? / wo?	für, um, durch, gegen, ohne (accusative preps) dative preps (rhyme it) two-way prepositions — the ONLY thing to memorise
der -> den -> dem mirrors er -> ihn -> ihm Say the noun with its article before choosing a pronoun	if one is solid, the other follows der Apfel -> der -> ihn

10.2 The learning rules this repo runs on

- **Nothing is FUNCTIONAL until it survives a real overnight gap.** A clean first attempt is not retention — this has been proven wrong twice.
- **Max 2 new grammar concepts per week.** Extra hours buy depth, not scope.
- **Every new word must appear in a sentence you produced the same day.**
- **Retrieval beats review.** Producing from memory beats re-reading, always.
- **Errors under load are the real data.** A fast flawed answer reveals more than a slow careful one.

10.3 Writing vs voice — they measure different things

	Writing tests	Voice tests
Conjugation endings	(correct)	(wrong) STT silently repairs them
Article endings	(correct)	(wrong)
Spelling, umlauts	(correct)	(wrong)
Word order	(correct)	(correct)
Retrieval speed	(wrong) unlimited time	(correct)
Automaticity	(wrong)	(correct)

Rule: learn in writing, prove in voice. Never infer grammar knowledge from a voice transcript — on day one it both hid a real error and invented a competence that wasn't there.

10.4 Your demonstrated strengths

Worth knowing, because they shape how to study:

1. **Self-correction is your strongest skill.** Across the 09-10/11 concepts test and the 09-15 review, you resolved most gaps yourself once pointed at the right reference — that's debugging your own understanding, not memorising.
2. **You generalise patterns correctly to untaught material** — produced “Setzen Sie sich,” “Öffnen Sie das Fenster,” and “Das Buch gehört mir” using verbs never formally taught.
3. **You notice real linguistic nuance unprompted** — the Heute-fronting emphasis observation (09-17) is a genuine insight, not a taught rule.
4. **You question things that don't add up** — asking why “gegangen” isn't the participle, catching untaught vocabulary in test prompts.

10.5 What to prioritise right now

1. **[HIGH] Dative-only verbs** (helfen/danken/gehören + mir/dir/ihm/ihr) — active cluster regression
2. **[HIGH] es -> ihm, sie -> ihr** — 3rd recurrence
3. **[MED] weil:** verb-last inside the clause AND verb-second in the main clause, both at once
4. **[MED] unsere (acc. pl.) vs unseren (dat. pl.)** — kill the “-en means plural” rule
5. **[MED] Perfekt participles** — pure memorisation, no shortcut exists
6. **[OK] aus vs von** — never yet drilled in isolation

APPENDIX — QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Articles: der/den/dem · die/die/der · das/das/dem · die/die/den+n

Pronouns: ich-mich-mir · du-dich-dir · er-ihn-ihm · sie-sie-**ihr** · es-es-**ihm** · wir-uns-uns · ihr-euch-euch · sie-sie-ihnen

Dative preps: aus, außer, bei, mit, nach, seit, von, zu **Accusative preps:** für, um, durch, gegen, ohne (FUDGO) **Two-way:** in, an, auf, über, unter, vor, hinter, neben, zwischen -> *wohin?* = accusative · *wo?* = dative

Contractions: ins (in+das) · im (in+dem) · ans · am · zum (zu+dem) · zur (zu+der) · vom (von+dem) — **never with possessives**

Word order: verb 2nd · yes/no question verb 1st · weil verb last · Time–Manner–Place · separable prefix to the end · nicht before what it negates

Perfekt: haben/sein + participle at the end · sein = motion/state-change + sein/bleiben · haben = everything else